

Sangjoon “Joon” Lee, Ph.D.

Incoming Assistant Professor at Nanyang Technological University

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Assistant professor of **mechanical and aerospace engineering**, with a core focus on **high-fidelity CFD simulations coupled with AI/data-driven surrogates for physics-informed, cost-efficient aerodynamic optimization**. Expertise in leveraging high-performance computing and machine-learning inference techniques to pioneer **improved engineering designs in aerospace systems**. Committed to advancing the understanding of **aerosciences across scales** – ranging from heat exchangers, pipe flows, and HVAC systems to turbines, aircraft and environmental flows.

WORK
EXPERIENCE

NANYANG TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY – SINGAPORE	2026/11 –
Assistant Professor , School of Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering [2026/11 – Present]	
STANFORD UNIVERSITY – STANFORD, CA, UNITED STATES	2024/10 – 2026/10
Postdoctoral Scholar , Aerospace Design Lab [2026/01 – 2026/10]	
Postdoctoral Fellow , Center for Turbulence Research (CTR) [2024/10 – 2025/12]	
UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY – BERKELEY, CA, UNITED STATES	2020/01 – 2024/08
Graduate Student Researcher , Computational Fluid Dynamics (CFD) Lab [2020/01 – 2024/08]	
SEOUL NATIONAL UNIVERSITY – SEOUL, SOUTH KOREA	2016/09 – 2018/12
Researcher , Energy & Environmental Flow Lab (EEFL) [2017/09 – 2018/12]	
Research Intern , Turbulence, Flow Control & CFD Lab [2016/09 – 2017/12]	

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY – BERKELEY, CA, UNITED STATES	2019/08 – 2024/08
Ph.D. / M.S. in Mechanical Engineering Designated emphasis: Computational and Data Science and Engineering	
SEOUL NATIONAL UNIVERSITY – SEOUL, SOUTH KOREA	2012/03 – 2018/08
B.S. in Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering & B.B.A. (Bachelor of Business Administration) Honors: <i>Summa Cum Laude</i>	(involving 21-month military leave)
SEOUL SCIENCE HIGH SCHOOL – SEOUL, SOUTH KOREA	2009/03 – 2012/02

RESEARCH
GRANTS

Precourt Institute for Energy Seed Grant: SMC-001 Sustainable Mobility Center at Stanford University <i>Co-PI</i> · \$100,000 Highly efficient thermal management in hydrogen-powered aviation	2026/02 – 2027/01
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	NSF ACCESS Allocation: PHY250071 ACCESS by the U.S. National Science Foundation (NSF) <i>PI</i> · 1,500,000 HPC core-hours • Surface topography optimization for thermally-efficient dropwise condensation	2025/03 – 2027/02
FELLOWSHIPS	CTR Postdoctoral Fellowship (\$100,000) Center for Turbulence Research (CTR) at Stanford University	2024/10 – 2025/12
	Departmental Graduate Fellowship (\$23,825) College of Engineering at the University of California, Berkeley	2023/08 – 2023/12
	Ilju Overseas Ph.D. Scholarship (\$120,000), Study Abroad Doctoral Program Ilju Academy & Culture Foundation • Merit-based; selected as one of six recipients in 2019	2019/08 – 2023/07
	National Scholarship for Science and Engineering (Full-tuition) Korea Student Aid Foundation (KOSAF)	2012/03 – 2017/12
HONORS & AWARDS	Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor (OGSI) Award GSI Teaching & Resource Center at the University of California, Berkeley	2021
	Representative of the Engineering Class of 2018 , 72nd Summer Commencement Seoul National University	2018
TEACHING & TUTORING	UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY Graduate Student Instructor (GSI) • Computer Programming for Scientists and Engineers (ENGIN 7) • Aerospace Engineering Design (AERO ENG 10) • Experimentation and Measurements (MEC ENG 103)	2024 Sp 2022 Fa – 2023 Sp 2019 Fa – 2022 Sp
	SEOUL NATIONAL UNIVERSITY Undergraduate Tutor • Basic Calculus 1, 2 (007.098A, 007.102) • Basic Physics 1 (007.099A)	2013 Sp – 2013 Fa 2013 Sp
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	Journal Peer Reviewer • Journal of Building Performance Simulation (Taylor & Francis) • Journal of Computational Physics (Elsevier) • Journal of Fluid Mechanics (Cambridge University Press) • Physics of Fluids (AIP Publishing)	2026 – 2026 – 2025 – 2024 –
COMMUNITY OUTREACH	Stanford seeME & CTR² , Stanford University Volunteer (Teaching, Photographing & On-day Assistance) • On-campus hands-on classes for young students to learn various aspects of engineering	2025
	SNU Tomorrow's Engineers Membership (Gongwoo) , Seoul National University Member & Head Manager • Annual <i>Vision Mentoring</i> events for high school students interested in engineering and science	2016 – 2018

PEER-REVIEWED
ARTICLES

* corresponding

† co-first

1. **Lee, S. & Wang, J. (2026). MLegS: Modernized and Parallelized Mapped Legendre Spectral Method Code for Radially Unbounded Simulations.** In Preparation.
2. **Lee, S. & Vijay, S. (2026). Data-Driven Topology-Aware Permeability Modeling Framework for Porous Structure.** In Preparation.
3. **Lee, S., Sheikh, H. M. (2026). Riblet Multi-Objective Optimization.** In Preparation.
4. **Lee, S., Yildizdag, M. E., & Sheikh, H. M. (2026). Topology Optimization of Dimpled Surfaces,** In Preparation.
5. **Jung, J., Lee, S. & Gu, G. X. (2026). Data-Driven Optimization of Novel Morphing Airfoil Designs for Enhanced Flutter Control,** In Preparation.
6. **Hong, J., Lee, S.[†], Lee, D., Bae, J. & Hwang, W. (2026). Experimental and Numerical Investigation of 3D Flow Structures in a Turbulent Channel Flow with Riblets,** *Experiments in Fluids*, Under Review.
7. **Wang, J., Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2026). Perturbation Analysis of Triadic Resonance in Columnar Vortices: Selection Rules and the Roles of External Forcing and Critical Layers,** *Journal of Fluid Mechanics*, Under Review.
8. **Duarte, C., Raftery, P., Lee, S., & Solmaz, A. S. (2026). Room Surface Convective Heat Transfer with Ceiling Fans and Its Effect on Radiant Cooling Systemss.** *Journal of Building Performance Simulation*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19401493.2026.2656928>.
9. **Lee, S. & Sheikh, H. M. (2026). Airfoil Optimization using Design-by-Morphing with Minimized Design-Space Dimensionality.** *Journal of Computational Design and Engineering*, 13 (1), 108–124. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcde/qwaf124>.
10. **Lee, S., Song, H., & Lele, S. K. (2025). Global Stability Analysis for Multidimensional Flow using an Augmented State Vector Formulation.** In *CTR Annual Research Briefs 2025* (pp. 313–323). Center for Turbulence Research, Stanford University. https://web.stanford.edu/group/ctr/ResBriefs/2025/28_Lee.
11. **Lee, S., Vijay, S. (2025). Topology-Aware Permeability Modeling in Structured Porous Media for Passive Flow Control.** In *CTR Annual Research Briefs 2025* (pp. 351–361). Center for Turbulence Research, Stanford University. https://web.stanford.edu/group/ctr/ResBriefs/2025/31_Lee.
12. **Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2025). Transient Growth of a Wake Vortex and its Initiation via Inertial Particles.** *Journal of Fluid Mechanics*, 1014, A16. <https://doi.org/10.1017/jfm.2025.253>.
13. **Lee, S., Baek, S., Ryu, J., Song, M. & Hwang, W. (2025). Flow in Ribbed Cooling Channels with Additive Manufacturing-Induced Surface Roughness.** *Physics of Fluids*, 37(6), 065118. <https://doi.org/10.1063/5.0268180>.
14. **Lee, S.^{*}, Sheikh, H. M., Lim, D. D., Gu, G. X., & Marcus, P. S. (2024). Bayesian-Optimized Riblet Surface Design for Turbulent Drag Reduction via Design-by-Morphing with Large Eddy Simulation.** *Journal of Mechanical Design*, 146(8), 081701. <https://doi.org/10.1115/1.4064413>.

15. Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2023). **Linear Stability Analysis of Wake Vortices by a Spectral Method Using Mapped Legendre Functions.** *Journal of Fluid Mechanics*, 967, A2. <https://doi.org/10.1017/jfm.2023.455>.
16. Sheikh, H. M., Lee, S.[†], Wang, J. & Marcus, P. S. (2023). **Airfoil Optimization using Design-by-Morphing.** *Journal of Computational Design and Engineering*, 10 (4), 1443–1459. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcde/qwad059>.
17. Lee, S., & Hwang, W. (2019). **Development of an Efficient Immersed-Boundary Method with Subgrid-Scale Models for Conjugate Heat Transfer Analysis using Large Eddy Simulation.** *International Journal of Heat and Mass Transfer*, 134, 198–208. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijheatmasstransfer.2019.01.019>.
18. Baek, S., Lee, S., Hwang, W., & Park, J. S. (2019). **Experimental and Numerical Investigation of the Flow in a Trailing Edge Ribbed Internal Cooling Passage.** *Journal of Turbomachinery*, 141 (1), 011012. <https://doi.org/10.1115/1.4041868>.

CONFERENCE
PAPERS &
PRESENTATIONS

1. Park, J., Lee, S., Li, J., Chen, K. W., Izuhara, I. & Schiavon, S. (2026, May 18–22). **A Simulation Study on Condensation Risk in Radiant Cooling Panels with Elevated Air Movement.** 12th International Conference on Indoor Air Quality, Ventilation & Energy Conservation in Buildings, Los Angeles, CA, United States (no. 02027). IAQVEC Association. <https://doi.org/10.1051/e3sconf/202671602027>. *Best Paper Award*.
2. Lee, S. & Vijay, S. (2025, Nov 23–25). **Topological Design of Porous Structures for Flow Control: A Design-by-Morphing Approach.** 78th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Houston, TX, United States (no. J32.3). American Physical Society.
3. Hong, J., Lee, S., Lee, D., Bae, J. & Hwang, W. (2025, Sep 15–19). **Experimental and Numerical Investigation of 3D Flow Structures in a Turbulent Channel Flow with Riblets.** 16th International Symposium on Experimental and Computational Aerothermodynamics of Internal Flows (ISAIF), Prague, Czechia (no. C7.1). Institute of Thermomechanics, Czech Academy of Sciences.
4. Lee, S., Wang, J. & Marcus, P. S. (2024, Nov 24–26). **Modernized and Parallelized Mapped Legendre Spectral Method Code for Unbounded Vortical Flow Simulations.** 77th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Salt Lake City, UT, United States (no. L16.7). American Physical Society.
5. Wang, J., Lee, S. & Marcus, P. S. (2024, Nov 24–26). **Stability Analysis of the Q-Vortex: Critical Swirling Parameter Determination via Perturbation Theories and Resonant Triadic Perturbations in the Sub-Critical Region.** 77th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Salt Lake City, UT, United States (no. J38.5). American Physical Society.
6. Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2024, Aug 25–30). **Particle-Initiated Transient Growth of a Wake Vortex in Consideration of Condensation Trails.** 26th International Congress of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics (ICTAM), Daegu, South Korea (pp. 2009–2010). International Union of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics. <https://doi.org/10.979.11984760/98>.
7. Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2023, Nov 19–21). **Investigation of Triggering Vortex Instabilities with Inertial Particles.** 76th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Washington, DC, United States (no. ZC38.5). American Physical Society.

8. Wang, J., Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2023, Nov 19–21). **Three-Wave Resonance in Neutrally Stable Wake Vortices**. 76th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Washington, DC, United States (no. ZC38.2). American Physical Society.
9. Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2022, Nov 20–22). **Viscous Perturbation to Inviscid Wake Vortices: Perturbation Theory in Vortex Stability**. 75th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Indianapolis, IN, United States (no. Q11.7). American Physical Society.
10. Marcus, P. S., Wang, J. & Lee, S. (2022, Nov 20–22). **A General Framework for Destabilizing Neutrally-Stable Flows Applied to Aircraft Wake Vortices**. 75th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Indianapolis, IN, United States (no. L18.1). American Physical Society.
11. Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2021, Nov 21–23). **Linear Instability Analysis of Wake Vortices by a Spectral Method using Mapped Legendre Functions**. 74th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Phoenix, AZ, United States (no. E24.1). American Physical Society.
12. Wang, J., Lee, S., & Marcus, P. S. (2021, Nov 21–23). **Destabilizing Neutrally Stable Wake Vortices Using Degenerate Eigenmodes**. 74th Annual Meeting of the APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (APS-DFD), Phoenix, AZ, United States (no. E24.3). American Physical Society.
13. Lee, S., & Hwang, W. (2018, Jul 4–6). **Validation of a Conjugate Heat Transfer Code with Subgrid-scale Models for Turbulent Flow**. KSFM 2018 Summer Conference, Jeju, South Korea (pp. 197-198). Korean Society for Fluid Machinery.
14. Baek, S., Lee, S., Hwang, W. & Park, J. S. (2018, Jun 11–15). **Experimental and Numerical Investigation of the Flow in a Trailing Edge Ribbed Internal Cooling Passage**. ASME 2018 Turbo Expo: Turbomachinery Technical Conference and Exposition, Lillestrøm, Norway (no. GT2018-76741). American Society of Mechanical Engineers. <https://doi.org/10.1115/GT2018-76741>. *Journal-Quality Appraisal and Transferred to J. Turbomach.*
15. Lee, S. (2017, Nov 1–3). **2D Simulation of an Unsteady Flow around a Small Vertical Axis Wind Turbine Using an Immersed Boundary Method**. KSME 2017 Annual Conference, Jeju, South Korea (pp. 741–745). Korean Society of Mechanical Engineers. *Student Paper Award: Bronze.*
16. Baek, S., Lee, S. & Hwang, W. (2017, Nov 1–3). **Investigation of Fully Developed Turbulent Pipe Flow Using Magnetic Resonance Velocimetry (MRV) and Large Eddy Simulation (LES)**. KSME 2017 Annual Conference, Jeju, South Korea (pp. 581–583). Korean Society of Mechanical Engineers.

INVITED
TALKS &
SEMINARS

1. Lee, S. (2026, Feb 5). **Training-Free Design Generation through Morphing and Its Applications in Fluid Dynamics**. MAE 297 Seminar Series. Department of Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering, University of California, Davis: Davis, CA, United States.
2. Lee, S. (2025, Aug 19). **Topology Optimization of Complex Nonlinear Systems Using High-Performance Simulations and Data-Driven Approaches**. GTR Technical Research Society Seminar. Global Technology Research, Samsung Electronics: Suwon, South Korea.
3. Lee, S. (2025, Jan 10). **Unmasking Hidden Physics and Bridging Data Sparsity: Two Paths to Tackling Fluid Problems**. CTR Tea Seminar. Center for Turbulence Research, Stanford University: Stanford, CA, United States.

4. Lee, S. (2024, Sep 10). **Physics-Based Computation in the Modern Era of Data-Driven Fluid Mechanics**. SNU Mechanical Engineering Seminar. Department of Mechanical Engineering, Seoul National University: Seoul, South Korea.
5. Lee, S. (2023, Aug 8). **Design-by-Morphing (DbM): A Novel Design Methodology for Aerodynamic Optimization**. 2023 Hyundai Vision Conference. Hyundai Motor Company: Seoul, South Korea.
6. Lee, S. (2022, Nov 16). **Modern Applications of Computational Fluid Dynamics (CFD)**. 2022 Online Special Lecture Series: Research Reinforcement for Sustainable Buildings and Urban Systems in Future. Department of Architectural and Urban Systems Engineering, Ewha Womans University: Online.
7. Lee, S. (2018, Aug 8). **An Introduction to In-House LES: Applications to Turbine Internal Cooling and Recent Improvements for Conjugate Heat Transfer Analysis**. KARI Computational Fluid Dynamics Seminar. Korea Aerospace Research Institute: Daejeon, South Korea.

SOFTWARE &
CODES

1. Lee, S., Wang, J. (2025). **MLegS: Modernized and Parallelized Mapped Legendre Spectral Method Code** (v1.0.2). <https://github.com/ucbCFD/MLegS>.
2. Lee, S. (2025). **roughSurfaceGen: Artificial Rough Surface Generator that Fits Prescribed Surface Roughness Parameters** (v1.0.1). <https://github.com/jun9303/roughSurfaceGen>.